

Optional explanations and first-draft revision in two fictional seminar sections

Fictional Team Alder | Entirely fictional | Local identifier REC-001

Abstract and scope

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Background

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Protocol and questions

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Method - assignment

Section assignment followed the existing timetable; no random allocation was performed. The explanation section and comparison section were already intact before the authored exercise began. Baseline revision scores differed, so this comparison cannot identify a causal effect.

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Measures and evidence boundaries

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Analysis plan

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Results - Table 2

The fictional available-case summaries are shown below. The means are descriptive and retain their group denominators.

Table 2. Descriptive revision-quality summaries

group	n	revision quality mean	SD
optional explanation	28	3.4	0.6
suggestion only	25	3.1	0.7

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Interpretation

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Limitations

The groups differed at baseline and the analysis does not identify a causal effect. The tiny authored sample cannot establish effectiveness, fairness, generalisation, or policy relevance.

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